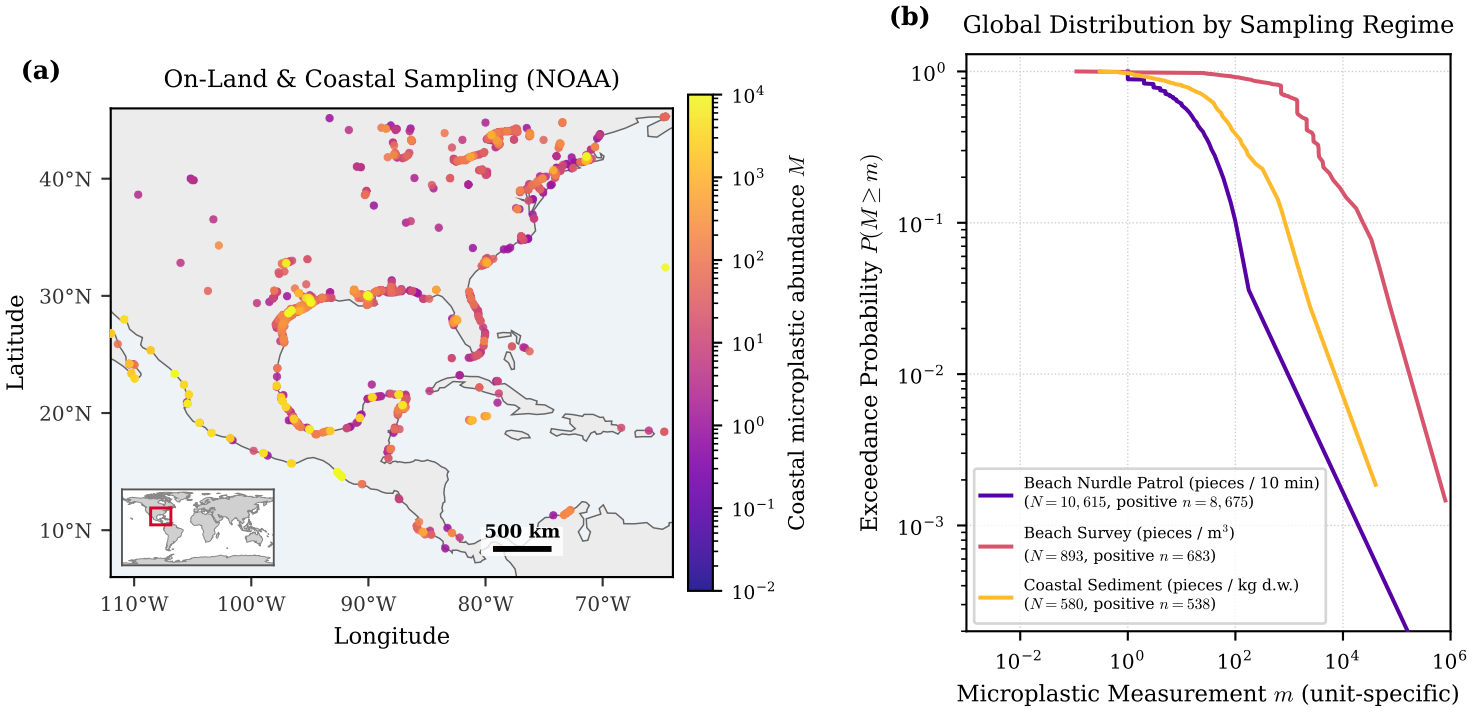

(a)
On-Land & Coastal Sampling (NOAA)
40°N
30°N
20°N
10°N
Latitude
110°W
100°W
90°W
80°W
70°W
Longitude
500 km
10^{4}
10^{3}
10^{2}
10^{1}
10^{0}
10^{-1}
10^{-2}
Coastal microplastic abundance M
(b)
Global Distribution by Sampling Regime
10^{0}
10^{-1}
10^{-2}
10^{-3}
Exceedance Probability $P(M \geq m)$
Beach Nurdle Patrol (pieces / 10 min)
($N = 10,615$, positive $n = 8,675$)
Beach Survey (pieces / m^3)
($N = 893$, positive $n = 683$)
Coastal Sediment (pieces / kg d.w.)
($N = 580$, positive $n = 538$)
10^{-2}
10^{0}
10^{2}
10^{4}
10^{6}
Microplastic Measurement m (unit-specific)